

Getting started on XCode

There are subtle differences between the way that iOS and OS X devices function in terms of accepting user inputs and displaying outputs. Whereas iOS deals with only one screen of content at a time, OS X can support multiple windows at the same time. Buttons, labels and text fields can be moved around on the top-level objects on OS X along with the option for the user to drag these around as required. This adds another layer of complication to apps that are required to run on OS X. However, iOS deals only with single screens which are individually managed by view controllers which are embedded into the window. In this sense, iOS requires lesser instructions on how the content has to be displayed as the content occupies the same positions on the screen at every run of the app and isn't changed.

We will opt for the simpler option and create an iOS only app. To get things rolling, open the application and select the option that allows you to create a new XCode project. In this instance, we will create a Single View Application. The next dialogue box that opens when you click on the 'Next' button is the page where you enter developer details. It has the following set of boxes:

- **Product Name**
- **Organization Name**
- **Organization identifier:** An external link that provides additional information about your organization through a website.
- **Bundle Identifier:** Automatically generated
- **Language:** In this option, select Swift
- **Devices:** Here, select Universal. This will compile your application to work on iPhones and iPads
- **Use Core Data:** Unselected
- **Include Unit tests:** Selected
- **Include UI tests:** Unselected. This will provide another level of verification to the code to ensure that all UI components are functioning.

On clicking next, you are prompted to select a location to save your project. On doing this, the Workspace window opens.

The workspace has four key sections: A Toolbar on top, a navigator area on the left, a central editor area and a utility area on the right. The good thing about running your app on an XCode template is that it automatically renders your app for you. So, even without writing any code, you can still simulate your app by clicking the simulate button.

Of course, it does absolutely nothing for now. To simulate it choose a particular platform on the scheme pop-up menu on the toolbar. Clicking